

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

Should We Eat Less Rice?

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 20

No.	Sentence
1	A food eaten regularly by many people can be called a _____.
2	Rice farming is under pressure from droughts and floods linked to _____.
3	Around four billion people depend on rice as their _____.
4	Brown, long-grained and basmati rice are examples of rice _____.
5	Current research aims to improve rice's environmental _____.
6	The new farming method is called _____.
7	In AWD, measuring pipes are installed _____.
8	One target of AWD is methane-emission _____.
9	Farmers were worried that trying AWD might reduce their _____.
10	Besides saving resources, the amount of rice produced also _____.

11 **What does Dr Pinto emphasise about rice?**

- A It is mainly a luxury food in Europe.
- B It feeds a very large share of the global population.
- C It is grown only in South and Southeast Asia.
- D It has recently stopped being popular in Africa.

12 **What is a major aim of current rice research?**

- A To make rice depend on constant flooding only.
- B To remove traditional rice varieties from farms.
- C To reduce demand for rice in Asia.
- D To develop rice that copes with water extremes.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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- 13 **What does "appetite" mean in this part of the discussion?**
- A A strong global demand for rice.
 - B A physical hunger caused by rice farming.
 - C A preference only for basmati rice.
 - D A decrease in rice consumption worldwide.
- 14 **What is presented as a possible way to make rice farming greener?**
- A Growing rice only in Europe.
 - B Replacing rice with potatoes.
 - C Using a method called Alternate Wet Drying.
 - D Flooding paddies more often than before.
- 15 **Why are measuring pipes used in AWD?**
- A To keep the paddies flooded permanently.
 - B To let farmers monitor field water levels.
 - C To measure the amount of rice sold.
 - D To increase methane emissions deliberately.
- 16 **What happened in the AWD experiment mentioned?**
- A Over a thousand farmers used the method to cut methane emissions.
 - B Only a few farmers tested AWD without clear targets.
 - C Farmers used AWD mainly to increase water use.
 - D The technique was tested without involving farmers.
- 17 **Why were some farmers hesitant about AWD?**
- A They did not understand what rice was used for.
 - B They preferred to grow only European rice varieties.
 - C They wanted more floods caused by climate change.
 - D They feared losing income from their crops.
- 18 **What would help persuade farmers to keep using AWD?**
- A A promise that no measurements are needed.
 - B A guarantee that rice farming will stop.
 - C Clear evidence of better results after harvest.
 - D Proof that methane emissions are irrelevant.

19 **What was the overall result of using AWD?**

- A It saved water but reduced rice output.
- B It improved efficiency, emissions and yield at the same time.
- C It helped farmers only by increasing electricity use.
- D It had no measurable impact after harvest.

20 **What can be inferred about AWD from the final outcome?**

- A It is useful only when farmers accept lower yields.
- B It solves climate change completely.
- C It works by making rice a less popular food.
- D It can offer both environmental and practical farming benefits.